Health

Purpose: *To show our bodies are the temple of the Holy Spirit. As our creator, redeemer and father, God is intimately concerned with the health of the whole person-body, mind & spirit.*

Centred on: *Jesus Christ came so that we may have life & life more abundantly.*

New Start acronym:

- **N**utrition
- **E**xercise
- **W**ater
- **S**unlight
- **T**emperance
- **A**ir
- **R**est
- **T**rust in God

John 10: 10…Jesus came to give **abundant** life! This is the cornerstone of the life and ministry of Jesus. But what did it mean for Jesus that life may be abundant?

Matthew 4: 23…According to this text, Jesus is concerned not only about the spirituality of his people but also their physical wellbeing.

Original plan:

Genesis 2: 5, 15…Here we find some ***pre sin*** health principles initiated right from the beginning (Exercise).

Genesis 3: 17-19… Right after sin, God is introducing exercise that requires sweat. He would have to work and have physical exertion. By working outside Adam would also be outside getting **Sunshine and Fresh Air.**

This refers specifically to the husbandman, who must live by forcing from a reluctant earth food for himself and his family, but it applies equally to all other vocations. Since Adam's fall human achievement may be realized only through toil. Nevertheless, it should be recognized that this punishment was indeed a blessing in disguise for sinful beings. When a man works he is far less likely to sin than when he spends his days in idleness. Toil and labour develop character and teach man humility and cooperation with God.

This is one reason why the Christian church has generally found its most loyal adherents and supporters among the labouring class. Work, even when arduous, should not be despised; "a blessing is in it."

Important note: It should be noticed again that God did not curse either Adam or his wife. Curses were pronounced only upon the serpent and the ground. But "cursed is the ground for thy sake," God said to Adam.

What about rest?

Genesis 2: 2-3…Right from the start, God in his wisdom laid down the foundation of resting from one's own personal endeavours for at least one 24hour period in amongst the week. Here God not only stipulated a day of rest but also leads by his example.

Mark 6: 29-32…J Great time to point out the benefit of the Sabbath again. Disciples have been running around getting things done, and Jesus says you need to take time to rest.

Also significant that they went to a secluded place. In verse 32 it says people didn't have time to even eat.

Nutrition:

Genesis 1: 27-29…Original diet: We learn from the divine record that man was to eat of the products of both field and tree, in other words of grain, nuts, and fruit; the animals, to eat of "every green herb," vegetables, or green plants, and grass.

Genesis 3: 18…Post sin diet: ***The herb***: The divine punishment provided also a partial change in diet. We evidently are to conclude that the quantity and quality of grains and nuts and fruits originally given to man were, as a result of the curse, reduced to such an extent that man would be required to look to the herbs for a portion of his daily food. This change may also have been due in part to the loss of certain elements from the tree of life, to a change in climate, and perhaps most of all to man's sentence to hard labour in the process of earning a livelihood.

Daniel 1: 1-17…Here we find Daniel requests a simple bible based diet and later this proves to be a testimony to his God.

But doesn't the bible support a diet of animal flesh?

Genesis 7: 15-24…The context here is that God has destroyed the entire earth with a flood. Therefore the earth is barren of all vegetation for a time.

Genesis 9: 1-4…God is now expanding the diet to allow for meat with the provision explicitly mentioning that meat should not have blood in it.

Note: In depth study of the genealogy of man both pre and post flood will reveal a rapid decline in the life span. Is this perhaps partially due to this change in diet?

Genesis 7: 1-2…Note the mention of *seven of every clean* animal and *two of every unclean.*

Genesis 8: 20…This is the rationale for the additional clean animals. Both for food and for sacrificial purposes.

Leviticus 3: 17…Again further insight to the hygiene principles of diet.

Deuteronomy 14: 3- 20…Note the simple yet well-defined principles that the Bible lays down for the classification of clean and unclean meats. (Further details see Leviticus 11).

Land Animals	Sea Animals	Flying Animals
Split Hoof Chews the Cud	Fins Scales	List provided/clean birds.

As a follower of Christ do you want to do the least to sweep by, or do you want to do what is going to please God as your Saviour? **Nutrition**

Now we are going to move into another area of health where God wants us to prosper.

Temperance:

Proverbs 23: 29-35…Simple straight forward advice from the writings of Solomon in relation to alcohol consumption.

1 Corinthians 10: 31…whether you eat or drink, do all to the glory of God. In every choice we want to follow God and honor Him. Have the things we've studied today been new information to you? Did you understand what we were talking about? So how did you relate to how some meats are not clean and some are? You need to see if what you studied has really sunk in, or whether or not they understand the implications of this. So how are you feeling about moving forward in this? Is there anything that would keep you from moving forward in your knowledge of his? You are trying to help people process what they are learning.

Philippians 2: 12-13…***Your own salvation:*** Paul was not present to help the Philippian believers personally; they had to care for their own spiritual needs. Salvation is an individual matter. No human friend, no pastor, not even an apostle, can work it out for another. "Though Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it [the land], … they shall deliver neither son nor daughter; they shall but deliver their own souls by their righteousness" (Eze. 14:20).

Fear and trembling: Paul is not advocating a slavish terror, but a wholesome self-distrust. The Christian should fear lest his will not be continually surrendered to Christ, or lest the carnal traits of character should control the life. He must fear to trust his own strength, to withdraw his hand from the hand of Christ, or to attempt to walk the Christian pathway alone (COL 161). Such fear leads to vigilance against temptation (1 Peter 1:17; 5:8), to humility of mind (Rom. 11:20), to taking heed lest we fall (1 Cor. 10:12).

Psalm 84: 11…No good thing does He withhold from those who walk uprightly. God wants what will be a blessing to us and what will give us an abundant life.

Psalm 34: 10…Again, those whom seek the Lord lack nothing.

Objections:

Acts 10: 1-36…This is an often misunderstood chapter used to support the consumption of unclean meats. When read and understood in its context, Paul is actually receiving guidance and education about the fact That God shows no partiality and the Gospel is available to all.

Mark 7: 18, 19…This text may be perceived as Jesus declaring that all food is now clean and acceptable in the diet. We must read all scripture in its context. (read entire chapter).

Unwashed hands. Mark defines what he means by "defiled." The washing here referred to was strictly ritualistic, not sanitary. This rite is said to have consisted of pouring a small quantity of water upon the fingers and palm of first one hand and then the other with the hand titled so that the water ran from the palm to the wrist, but no farther (all the time care being taken lest the water run back into the palm), and then alternately rubbing one hand with the palm of the other hand. The minimum amount of water prescribed was that which could be contained in one and a half egg shells. It seems, however, that where water was not available a dry ablution was permitted in which a person would simply go through the motions of washing his hands in the prescribed manner.

Note: in the next few verses, Jesus places a marked distinction between the ***traditions/commandments of*** **men** and the ***commandments of God.***

In essence, Jesus is declaring that you don't catch gentile Kootees so to speak by not following the manmade tradition of hand washing. Furthermore, in verse 19, where it mentions *"thus purifying all foods,"* Foods: βρῶμα [*broma* /**bro**·mah/] that which is eaten, food.

In the Hebrew mind, a pig for example was not regarded as food just as we wouldn't regard a house brick as food. Jesus is simply saying that ALL that is food (able to be eaten) is clean. Jesus has already declared what is unclean or unfit for human consumption on the basis of Hygiene.
So Jesus is saying the commandments of men are not binding and that the commandments of God are binding.

John 2: 1-11…Here Jesus has miraculously provided 120-180 Gallons of alcohol for a wedding celebration right?

Old Testament: Hebrew	New Testament: Greek
יַיִן [yayin /yah·yin/]	οἶνος [oinos /oy·nos/]
Wine	Wine

- Unfermented
- Fermented

The only way we can discern wether the scriptures are speaking of fermented wine as opposed to unfermented wine is based on the context.

Firstly, many have noted that as it was the time of the Passover (verse 13), this was about six months after the time of the grape harvest. Now due to this fact and the supposably insufficient methods of storage in those days, it would be impossible to have any fresh (unfermented) grape juice available.

With little research, one will find that in ancient times they did in fact have several many methods of storage and preservation of produce. For example:

- Boiling the juice down to syrup.
- Separating the fermentable pulp from the juice by filtration.
- Placing the juice in sealed jars and immersing them in cold water.
- Fumigating the wine jars with sulphur before sealing them.

The morality argument:
Consistently in the scriptures we find that drunkenness is entirely condemned. Is it feasible to assume that Jesus just turned approx 120-180 gallons of alcohol? Is it credible to assume that no one would be expected to leave that feast without being heavily intoxicated? Is this consistent with the character of Christ?

Matthew 26: 26-29… At the time of Passover all leaven/yeast was removed from within the Jewish household. In addition, note the mention of the wine being symbols of Christ's blood, furthermore, note the statements *"fruit of the vine"* and *"drink it new."*

1 Timothy 5: 23… In Paul's day, as now, the water in many localities was often unsafe for use. Physical ailments such as dysentery, often due to contaminated water, were common occurrences. Consequently, other ways to quench thirst were often recommended. Some commentators believe that Paul here advocates the temperate use of fermented wine for medicinal purposes. They call attention to the fact that wine has, through the centuries, thus been used.

Others hold that Paul refers to unfermented grape juice, their reasoning being that he would not give advice inconsistent with the rest of Scripture, which warns against the use of intoxicating beverages (see Prov. 20:1; 23:29–32).

Romans 14: 2; 14-15; 20-21… Unclean. Gr. koinos, literally, "common." This term was used to describe those things which, though "common" to the world, were forbidden to the pious Jew (see on Mark 7:2). The foods that the "weak" (v. 1) brother refrains from eating, but which the strong brother allows, are not the kinds of foods that are unclean in their own nature, but owe their taint to conscientious scruples (see on v. 23). Paul is not here sweeping away all distinctions between foods.

The interpretation must be limited to the particular foods under discussion and to the specific problem with which the apostle is dealing, namely, the sympathetic treatment of those whose partly-enlightened consciences prevent their eating certain foods.

The uncleanness does not lie in the nature of the food but in the believer's view of it. **The "weak"** (v. 1) **Christian believes he ought not to eat foods offered to idols,** for example, and makes it a matter of conscience to abstain from such foods. So long as he holds this conviction, it would be wrong for him to partake. He may be in error, judged from another's point of view, but it would not be proper for him to act in violation of what he conscientiously supposes God requires (see v. 23).

Note: The secrets of longevity by Dan Buettner (Nov 2005)… States that the three healthiest study groups are the Sardinians, the Okinawans & the Seventh Day Adventists.